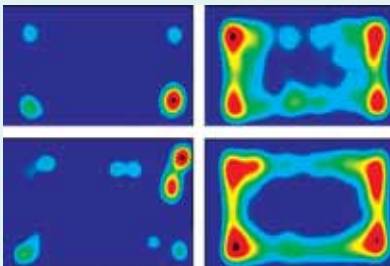


Open source algorithm can improve the reliability of autistic mice study

A new open source program has the potential to increase the reliability and depth of data acquired from a marble-burying assay, which is routinely used in autistic mice models to infer anxious or repetitive behaviours. The program tracks a mouse's movement, counts how many marbles it buries, and keeps track of how long it takes to do so.

Researchers generally photograph mice in a cage with many marbles in order to do this test. They take another photograph after a specified period of time has passed and compare the two. Mice with anxiety-like or repetitive habits are known to bury more marbles than usual.

"The marble-burying assay, the way it's currently analysed, does show reproducible results," stated study investigator Lucas Wahl, a graduate student in Aleksandra Badura's lab at Erasmus University in Rotterdam, the Netherlands.



However, according to Badura, associate professor of neurology and the study's lead investigator, labs do the assay differently. "Behavioural studies are a little bit of a messy ground," he said. Machine learning is used to standardise the procedure in the new tool, which was detailed in *eNeuro* in March and is freely available online.

Intel takes over the Open Networking Foundation's development team

Intel has purchased the Open Networking Foundation's (ONF) development team as well as Ananki, an independent venture-backed company that was recently spun out of the ONF to supply open source based software-defined private 5G as a commercial service, according to a release. The financial details have been kept under wraps.



Guru Parulkar, the ONF executive director, has joined Intel as vice president of the Network and Edge Group, reporting to Nick McKeown, the founding ONF board member and senior vice president and general manager of Intel's Network and Edge Group. In addition, the majority of ONF's internal development team will join Intel's workforce.

As it transitions away from code development by an internal team, the Open Networking Foundation (ONF), which was founded in 2011 with the mission of transforming networking by championing software-defined networking (SDN), disaggregation, and open source, has released all of its projects to open source with permissive software licences. ONF has made its full portfolio of production-ready platforms open sourced, including solutions for public 5G (SD-Core, SD-RAN), private 5G networks (Aether), software-defined broadband (SEBA/VOLTHA), and P4 programmable networks (SD-Fabric, PINS).

"ONF has made important contributions to the industry with its software-defined development projects, and I am confident that its move to a community-sourced model as part of its next stage of growth will fuel further contributions as the industry and its needs advance," said Nick McKeown. "As a result of ONF's shift in direction, we are pleased to welcome ONF's development team to Intel."

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